
Create Your Own GPT

The Complete Setup Guide for Claude Code

Build your own AI-powered development ecosystem

[Voice](#) • [Images](#) • [Video](#) • [Search](#) • [1000+ Integrations](#) • [Memory](#)

WHAT'S INSIDE

- The CLAUDE.md Template — Your project's brain
- Key Prompts Collection — Copy-paste ready
- MCP Setup Commands — 6 essential tools
- Ecosystem Overview — How it all connects
- Beginner Tips & Warnings — Avoid common mistakes

Why Build Your Own System?

Instead of waiting for OpenAI to decide what features you want, take matters into your own hands. With Claude Code and MCP servers, you can build a **fully customizable AI system** that rivals — and often exceeds — what ChatGPT offers.



Voice Mode

Real-time conversations via Gemini Live API



Image Generation

Create diagrams and thumbnails with Gemini Imagen



Video Understanding

Analyze videos — something ChatGPT still can't do



Web Search & Scraping

Research and extract content from any website



1000+ App Integrations

Connect to Calendar, Email, Slack, Notion via Zapier



Custom Memory

Full control over what your AI remembers



Database Connections

Store data, build RAG systems with Supabase



The Best Part

Non-technical users can follow along. After a week of getting used to it, you'll never look back.

The CLAUDE.md File

The [CLAUDE.md](#) file is your project's brain — it tells Claude Code how to behave, what to remember, and how to work with your codebase. Think of it as ChatGPT's memory, except **you have full control**.

Example: Gemini API Project

```
# CLAUDE.md

## User Preferences
- **Animated diagrams**: Always prefer animated visuals
- **Simple analogies**: Use easy-to-understand explanations

## Project Overview
Reference documentation for Google Gemini API:
- Video Understanding
- Image Generation (Gemini native + Imagen 4)
- Real-time Voice Conversation
```

```
## Key Technical Details
- SDK: pip install -U google-genai pillow pyaudio
- Models: gemini-2.5-flash, gemini-3-pro-preview
```

Template Structure

Section	What to Include
Project Context	What the project is and what problem it solves
Tech Stack	Frontend, backend, database, styling frameworks
User Preferences	How Claude should communicate with you
Code Conventions	Naming patterns, file structure, comment style
Key Files	Help Claude navigate your codebase
Memory Rules	Persistent instructions using # hashtags

Key Prompts Collection



API Documentation Prompt

Use this with Claude or Perplexity to get comprehensive, up-to-date API docs:

```
Can you get me the latest documentation on how to use  
the latest version of [API NAME] as of today for:
```

1. Installation & Authentication
2. Current model names/strings
3. Complete working code examples
4. Rate limits & pricing

```
Create a markdown file of your findings.
```



Project Initialization

Type `/initialize` in Claude Code to have it analyze your project and create a CLAUDE.md file automatically.



Hashtag Memory Format

Use `#` at the start of a message to create persistent memories:

```
# always prefer Tailwind CSS for styling  
# always use async/await instead of .then() chains  
# never commit .env files  
# I love animated diagrams for explanations
```

How it works

Claude updates your CLAUDE.md file and remembers these instructions across all sessions in that project.



Image Generation Prompt

For technical diagrams and thumbnails with Gemini:

```
Create a fun, colorful infographic explaining [CONCEPT]  
designed for a 7th grader.
```

```
Use this simple analogy: [YOUR ANALOGY]
```

```
Style: Bright colors, cartoon-style, big readable text,  
fun icons, NO technical jargon.
```

MCP Setup Commands

MCP (Model Context Protocol) servers extend Claude Code's capabilities. Here are copy-paste ready commands for the essential tools:



ZAPIER — Calendar, Email, Slack, Notion + 1000 more

```
claude mcp add zapier \
  https://mcp.zapier.com/api/mcp/mcp \
  -t http \
  -H "Authorization: Bearer YOUR_TOKEN_HERE"
```

Get your token: mcp.zapier.com → Create MCP connection



FIRECRAWL — Web scraping, search, crawl, map URLs

```
claude mcp add firecrawl \
  -e FIRECRAWL_API_KEY=YOUR_API_KEY_HERE \
  -- npx -y firecrawl-mcp
```

Get your API key: firecrawl.dev



N8N — Workflow automation, webhooks, templates

```
claude mcp add n8n-mcp \
  -e N8N_API_URL=https://your-instance.app.n8n.cloud \
  -e N8N_API_KEY=YOUR_API_KEY_HERE \
  -- npx -y n8n-mcp
```

Get your API key: [n8n](https://n8n.io) → Settings → API → Create API Key



SUPABASE — Database, SQL, auth, storage, edge functions

```
claude mcp add supabase \
  -e SUPABASE_ACCESS_TOKEN=YOUR_TOKEN_HERE \
  -- npx -y @supabase/mcp-server-supabase@latest
```

Get your token: supabase.com/dashboard/account/tokens



PLAYWRIGHT — Browser automation, screenshots, testing

```
claude mcp add playwright -- npx @playwright/mcp@latest
```

No API key required — runs locally on your machine



21ST.DEV MAGIC — Generate React/Tailwind UI components

```
claude mcp add magic \
  -e API_KEY=YOUR_API_KEY_HERE \
  -- npx -y @21st-dev/magic@latest
```

Get your API key: 21st.dev

Managing Your MCPs

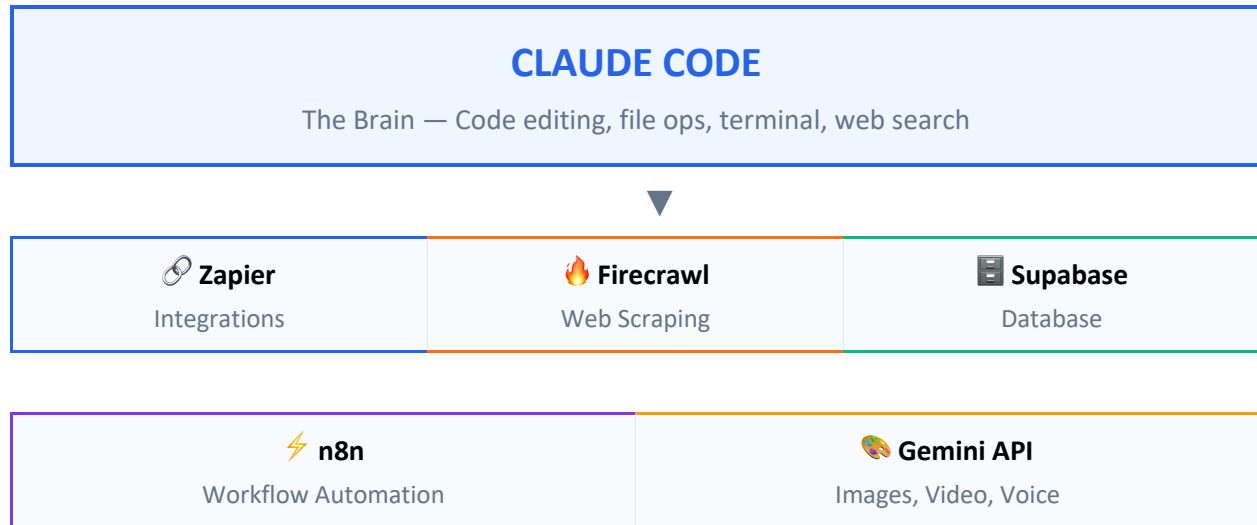
```
claude mcp list          # View all configured MCPs
claude mcp remove <name> # Remove an MCP
/mcp status              # Check status in session
```

 Important

Restart Claude Code after adding new MCPs for them to take effect.

Your AI Ecosystem

Here's how all the pieces connect together:



Example Workflow

User request: "Create a landing page and set up email capture"

1. Claude Code receives request and plans the work
2. 21st.dev Magic generates UI components
3. Claude Code writes React/Next.js code
4. Supabase creates table for email subscribers
5. Zapier sets up email notification for new signups
6. Playwright takes screenshot to verify result

Beginner Warnings & Tips

⚠️ YOLO MODE — Handle With Care

YOLO mode (`--dangerously-skip-permissions`) lets Claude execute commands without asking. Powerful but risky.

❌ RISKS

- Can delete files without asking
- Can run any terminal command
- Can commit/push to git automatically
- Can install packages without asking

✅ WHEN IT'S OK

- Disposable test environments
- Docker containers or VMs
- Projects with good git history
- When you know what you're doing

Recommended Permission Settings

✅ Safe to "Always Allow"

- Reading files
- Searching / grep operations
- Listing directories
- Git status / log / diff

⚠️ Review Every Time

- File writes / edits
- Terminal commands
- Git commits / pushes
- Installing packages

Cursor Extension Setup

1. Open Cursor IDE
2. Go to Extensions (Cmd/Ctrl + Shift + X)
3. Search for "Claude Code" and install
4. Go to Settings → Claude Code to configure

Common Gotchas

Problem	Solution
Claude forgets preferences	Add them to CLAUDE.md, not just chat
MCP won't connect	<code>claude mcp remove <name></code> then re-add
Unwanted changes	<code>git checkout -- <file></code> to revert
Claude Code is slow	Break large files, disable unused MCPs
Doesn't know recent APIs	Provide docs in CLAUDE.md or use Firecrawl
Context window exceeded	<code>/clear</code> or <code>/compact</code> to reset

Quick Reference

Essential Commands

Command	Description
claude	Start Claude Code
/initialize	Analyze project, create CLAUDE.md
/mcp status	Check MCP connection status
/clear	Clear conversation history
/compact	Compress context to save space
Shift + Enter	Multi-line input
Esc Esc	Cancel current operation
Tab	Toggle thinking display

Setup Checklist

- ☐ Create a CLAUDE.md file for every project
- ☐ Use git before making major changes
- ☐ Start with restricted permissions, expand as needed
- ☐ Keep API documentation files in your project
- ☐ Use hashtag memories for consistent behavior
- ☐ Test in a separate branch before merging
- ☐ Review Claude's changes before committing
- ☐ Back up important files before YOLO mode

Created for the "Create Your Own GPT" YouTube Series

youtube.com/@markkashef

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